including layouts, partial views, tag helpers, and view components. Now it is time to learn about the partner to the Razor page: the `PageModel` class.

In this section, you will learn about the two primary roles of a `PageModel`: *controller* and *view model*. Recall from the discussion in chapter 1 about the controller in MVC. You will remember that its role is to take requests, use the information in the bid to perform commands on the model, and then take the result of that processing and pass it to the view for display. Figure 3.7 shows the relevant part of the process.

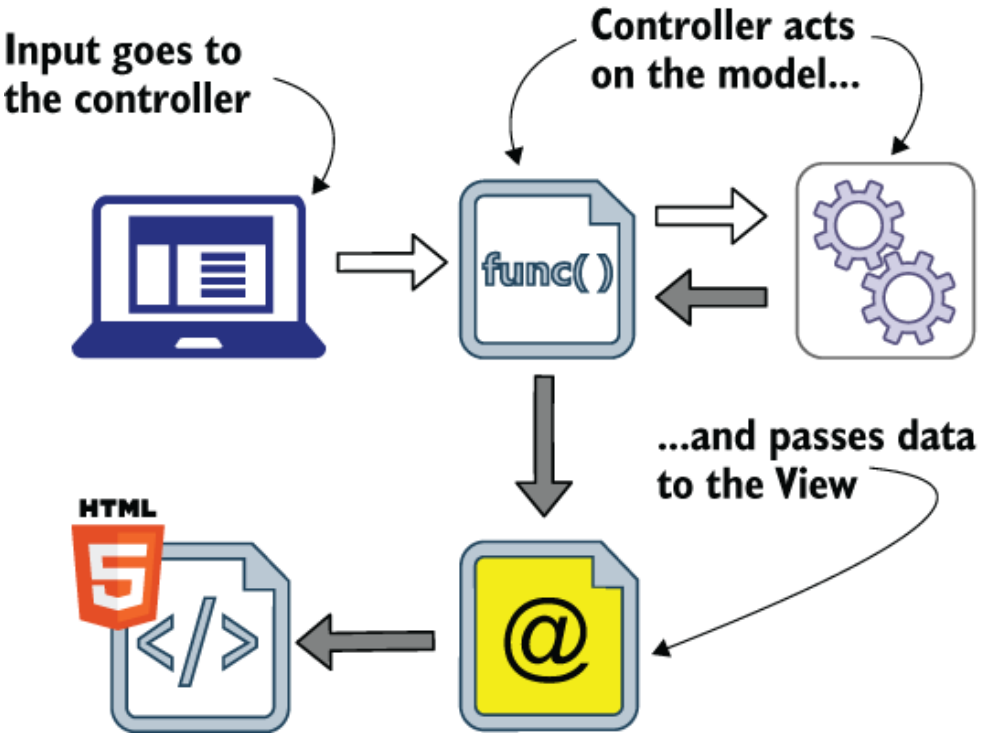


Figure 3.7 The controller takes the input, acts on the model, and passes the resulting data to the view.

As part of request processing, the controller has to prepare the view's data and make that available to the view in a form the view can work with. This form is referred to as a *view model* and is the focus of the first part of this section. Before that, I discuss `ViewData`, which also provides a way to pass data to view pages.